

"Castro has taken no interest in international situation or in threat of international Communism," the U.S. Ambassador complained shortly after the Revolution. "I tried to explain significance of support of all peoples of free world in great struggle between freedom and slavery but do not believe he was particularly impressed."[5] The "freedom" that U.S. policymakers worried about incessantly in the first months of the Revolution was what the new revolutionary regime would mean for private enterprise. " 'Real U.S. goals in Cuba', Assistant Secretary of State Roy Rubottom reiterated, included 'receptivity to U.S. and free world capital and increasing trade' and 'access by the United States to essential Cuban resources'."[6]

In late 2007, President Bush echoed the importance of private enterprise, the association of what he called "economic freedom" with political freedoms – and Cuba's failures on both counts. "One of the great success stories of the past century is the advance of economic and political freedom across Latin America," Bush explained in a major policy speech. "In this room are officials representing nations that are embracing the blessings of democratic government and free enterprise." However, "one country in our region still isolates its people from the hope that freedom brings, and traps them in a system that has failed them."[7] The one country, obviously, was Cuba.